



Basilitrix

What happened
in the
Warsaw Dungeons?

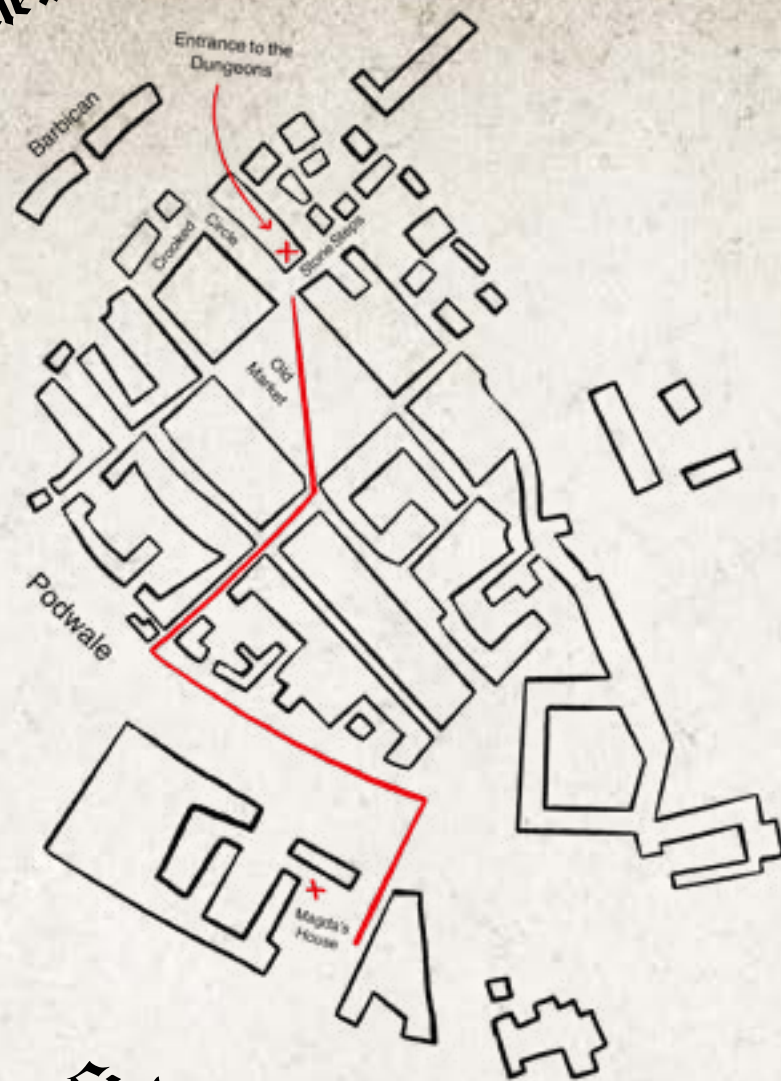
A musical by Ida Wrona



"A stone on stone, on stone a stone..." - (Wanda Chotomska)

Welcome to Warsaw - a city teeming with secrets and whispers of mythical creatures you wouldn't dare to dream of. Immerse yourself in the story of brave Magda, who embarks on a quest to save her little brother from the claws of a terrifying monster. Narrated by the ever-curious Rat Squad, this tale will have you in stitches.

Basilitrix is a story about bravery, sisterhood, compassion, and the courage to follow one's heart, even when the whole world seems to oppose it. Based on a Polish folk legend, this musical contains a unique jazz and rock blend that pleases younger and older audiences.



Song List:



Dance of the Shadows
Warsaw Buzz
How to Conquer the Basilisk
In the Dungeons
I am the Basilitrix
The Battle
Basilitrix's Lament
Time to End It / Under Warsaw
I am the Basilitrix - Reprise

Look Bob!



B-b-b...Basilitrix!!!



Cast



Yiyi Fan - The Ratmother

Yiyi is a singer, dancer, and performer from China. Having worked as a performer and assistant producer in several musical theatre productions in Shanghai, Yiyi hopes to bring a new perspective to Basilitrix.

www.instagram.com/fanyiyi98/



Alex Thackray - Bob

Alex is a writer, performer, and director. She has a particular interest in opera and audio drama.

www.instagram.com/apthackray/



Nicole Snell - Ratette

Nicole is a passionate singer, actress, and performer from South Africa. Having been in a competitive choral choir for 6 years, singing in many European, African, and Nordic languages, Nicole brings a diverse and unique flare to her performances. Nicole's dream is to play the part of Christine Daaé in the West End.

www.instagram.com/growingwith-nicole/



Eleanor Duncan - Magda

Eleanor is a singer, dancer and actress from Cyprus, born in the UK. Having worked on a range of new devising pieces and productions while studying at the University of Warwick, she is passionate about the development of new works, particularly those that have to do with cultural education and integration between nations.

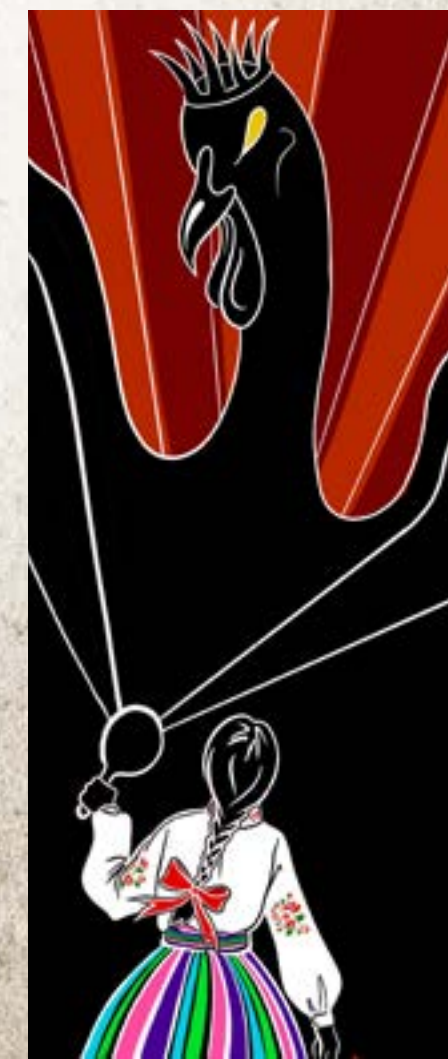
www.instagram.com/eleanor_clare_duncan/



Ida Wrona - Basilitrix

Ida is a singer, dancer, and musical theatre performer from Poland. She graduated from the ART Music School in Warsaw, specialising in Vocal Performance, and has completed Ableton-certified courses in music production. Ida's credits include portraying Mrs Bungee in William Finn's musical A New Brain at the KADR Cultural Centre in Warsaw. Ida will receive her MA in Musical Theatre Company from Leeds Conservatoire this August.

www.instagram.com/idawronaaa/



Band



Evie Kitching - Piano

Evie is a Grade 8 Pianist and Composer for Film and TV. Having just completed her degree in Film Music at Leeds Conservatoire, she hopes to begin a career professionally composing orchestral scores for films, particularly animations, alongside performing on piano in a wide range of styles.

www.instagram.com/eviekitching-music/



Tariq Megrissi - Drums

Tariq is a drummer, performer, event curator and educator, as well as the lead of MINDSUITTE, an improvised dance music collective based in Leeds. Tariq is always eager to learn and be apart of new projects, Basilatrix being the newest edition to his eclectic portfolio of creative endeavours.

www.instagram.com/legsndrums/



Elizabeth Cunningham - Trumpet

Elizabeth grew up playing the violin before moving to the clarinet, she played the piano through this time also. She is a choral scholar at Leeds Minster, following fifteen years of professional choral training. While at university, Elizabeth has picked up the trumpet. This will be her first trumpet performance.

www.instagram.com/elizabeth.cunningham/



Virag Zengo - Director

Vi is a Hungarian-born theatre creative who mainly focuses on directing and choreographing. Having lived in Budapest, the USA, and different parts of the UK, Vi brings her unique perspective to any project she works on, resulting in a fresh take on everyday stories.

www.instagram.com/virag.zengo.choreo/



Sam Newton - Musical Director

Sam is a musician, musical director and conductor based in Leeds. Graduating BA(Hons) Film Music from Leeds Conservatoire in 2024, he is about to start studying on the conservatoire's MA Musical Direction degree, hoping to explore the industry further and improve his skills.

www.instagram.com/sam_newton_music/



Elizabeth Cunningham - Assistant Musical Director

Elizabeth has recently finished the second year of her classical singing degree at Leeds Conservatoire, she founded and runs the Leeds Conservatoire Student Union Chorus. With an HNC and HND in Musical Theatre and years of conductor training behind her, she is looking forward to working with the creative team.

www.instagram.com/elizabeth.cunningham/



Rosie Bristow - Bass Guitar

Rosie is a BA Popular Music student at Leeds Conservatoire, going into her third year. Their main instrument is bass guitar, they specialise primarily in rock and metal. Rosie is involved in a number of bands in the Leeds alternative music scene and has acted as a session bassist for local metal and hardcore bands. Rosie has wide range of gigging experience, from thrash metal band 'Theocracide', to pit band work in musical theatre, and has been performing regular gigs in various cities around the UK for a number of years.

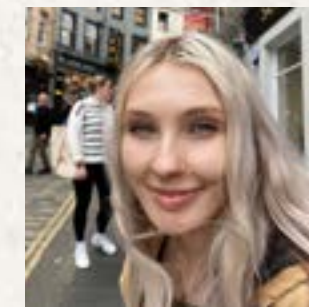
www.instagram.com/ro_zi_bristow/



Tom 'Linus' Houghton - Guitar

Guitarist **Tom 'Linus' Houghton** is a jazz undergraduate at Leeds Conservatoire. Blending his love of roots and country with his hard-bop jazz influences, he's played in, led, and composed for many bands, including his own quartet, the LCSU Big Band, and the GT Big Band, amongst others. He also regularly performs solo jazz guitar. In addition to his performance work, Linus contributes his talents on both guitar and steel guitar for session work across various genres, demonstrating a deep musical passion.

www.instagram.com/linushmusic/

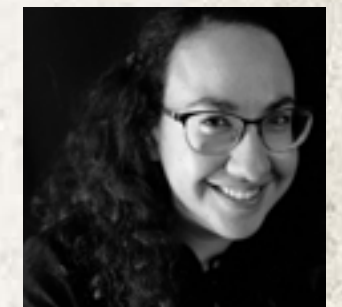


Katya Bonk - Illustrator & Graphic Designer

Katya/Katie has recently graduated with a BA(Hons) Visual Communication degree from Leeds Arts University. Her portfolio contains a wide variety of illustration, graphic design, and marketing. She is also the creator of BONK, an online platform, magazine and events organiser, which focuses on opportunities, people, places and events for alternative people in the North of England.

www.instagram.com/katyabonk.art/

www.instagram.com/by.bonk/



Alexandra Thomas - Assistant Writer

Alexandra is a writer from France. A former French language teacher and current librarian, she nurtures a deep passion for books, languages and Musical Theatre. In 2024, she co-wrote the book of a musical that performed in France and co-wrote the script of "Basilatrix", a first step to writing her own musicals.

www.instagram.com/alexpapergirl/



Ida Wrona - Writer, Songwriter & Producer

Ida is a writer, songwriter, performer, and producer from Poland. Before immersing herself in Musical Theatre, she worked in marketing, public relations and event organisation. She will earn her MA in Musical Theatre Company in August 2024. Ida was awarded a Principal Scholarship from the Leeds Conservatoire.

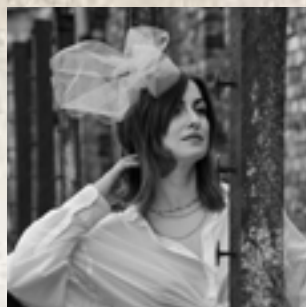
www.instagram.com/idawronaaa/



Michał Grodzki - Composer

Michał is a second-year piano student at the Krzysztof Komeda Popular and Jazz Music School in Warsaw, Poland. In addition to playing piano, he is also a guitarist and composer. He loves orchestral and film music but still enjoys heavy rock riffs. In 2022, he co-founded the Girl's Don't Sweat collective.

www.instagram.com/michal.grodzki7/



Anita Zawadzka - Composer

Anita, a drummer and graduate of ART Music School in Warsaw, currently plays in the Polish production of SIX at Syrena Musical Theatre. Her favourite music styles are hip-hop and Latino, and her favorite animal is a dog.

www.instagram.com/nicia_triceps/

Bazyliszek - Historia Śpiewana

Before Basilitrix evolved into an English book musical, it began as a concept album in Polish, with songs interwoven by a narrator telling the story. In this original album, Ida sang all the parts—Basilitrix's, Magda's, and Rats'. The album, "Bazyliszek - historia śpiewana" (Basilisk - A Sung Tale), is available on all streaming platforms

Listen via Spotify here:

open.spotify.com/album/1dpdeJPekV5k7WeJhL8vbW?si=DUvHK-D0rQayEN0Jc6MPN4A&nd=1&dlsi=1cfd0f8a1e304352

Listen via Youtube here:

www.youtube.com/playlist?list=OLAK5uy_n7CcqyNUWcfiwmC0eu-IFB0xOIFakFXUY0

You can stay up to date on Basilitrix via the Instagram:

www.instagram.com/basilitrix_musical/

Or the Website:

basilitrixmusical.com/



It all began in 2022 when the newly formed band Girl's Don't Sweat, decided to enter the "New Sounds of Warsaw Streets" contest. With the deadline approaching fast, Ida Wrona (singer, songwriter, composer), Michał Grodzki (pianist, composer), and Anita Zawadzka (drummer, composer) quickly came together to create "Ja Jestem Bazyliszek" ("I am the Basilitrix") and recorded it in a home studio.

Their song was so well received that it advanced to the finals. Ida, Michał, and Anita proudly performed "Ja Jestem Bazyliszek" on a big stage during the city festival, earning third prize from the Jury and second prize from the audience. After the performance, children approached Ida, dressed as the Basilitrix, to take pictures with her. Their parents mentioned how much their children loved the song and inquired where they could listen to it. This inspired Ida to develop a concept album, a musical story based on the legend.

Over the next few months, the band wrote and produced "Bazyliszek - historia śpiewana" ("Basilisk - a sung tale"). They recorded it with the help of Filip Gołda from 8records studio (electric guitar, mix, master), Radek Łukaszewicz (bass guitar), and Piotr Galar (trumpet). The album was released in May 2023.

When Ida was accepted into the Leeds Conservatoire in the spring of 2023, she began to consider translating and adapting Basilitrix into a stage play. When she heard about the Leeds Theatre Festival, she knew she wanted to take part in it. She translated the lyrics and, with the help of Alexandra Thomas, adapted the original story into the script. She recruited brilliant people, and thanks to them, Basilitrix has its premiere at:

**'The Venue' Leeds Conservatoire
20 July 2024.**





To Sam, Elizabeth, Virag, Eleanor, Nicole, Yiyi, Alex, Katya, Rosie, Evie, Tariq and Tom - thank you for believing in Basilatrix and me and investing your time in making this show happen. Every one of you is absolutely remarkable, and I am impressed by your skills, creativity, and musical sensitivity. Thank you for being reliable, invested, and open to share. I hope you enjoyed this project as much as I did and that we will have opportunities to work together again!

To Sam and Elizabeth, thank you for your hard work and the countless hours spent preparing sheet music, coordinating the band, and bearing with us during rehearsals.

To Gus Gowland - thank you for believing in Basilatrix and offering your support and advice whenever I needed it.

To Aaron Newland-Bentley, Sarah Redgwick, Adam Stadius, Andrew Griffiths, Aimee Shields, Nell Bradbury, Jacob Savage, Kathy Taylor-Jones, Laura McIntosh, Anna Cabré-Verdiell Bosch, Eilon Morris, Aaron Parker, Harriet Spence, Kirsty Sparks, Claire Eden, Craig Faulkner, Tyrrell Jones, Rebecca Reaney, thank you for the splendid classes you offered us, sharing your time, knowledge and feedback, and for genuinely caring. I feel fortunate to have had the opportunity to learn from you.

To Joseph French, thank you for your support, advice, and for offering brilliant solutions.

To Eleanor, Nicole, André and Lillie-Apple, thank you for your linguistic support.

To Michał, Anita, and Alex, thank you for being there for me and helping me make it all happen.

To Piotrek, thank you for always being by my side, believing in me and helping me with every crazy idea, like moving to the UK to make musicals. You're the best.

Dziękuję!
Ida

